



A War of Words:

Self-Awareness for Introverts

(and why programmers suck at salary negotiations)

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A Safe Place

- I ask that we make this place a ***Safe Place***
- People may have deep emotional responses
- Crying, yelling, hugging or otherwise awkward
- Please honor their emotional state
- As your emotions are honored
- No sarcasm, judgmental or “man up!” comments

Let it Be



Agenda

- **A Short Story About Emotional Processing**
- Dealing with the Aftermath
- More Short Stories
- More Strategies
- Salary Negotiations
- Wrap Up



A Short Story

- I'm Coding... In The Flow



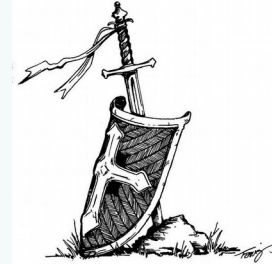
A Short Story

- I'm Coding... In The Flow
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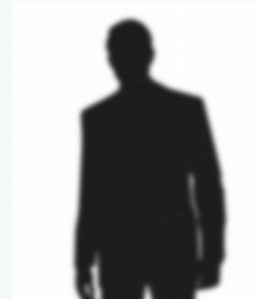
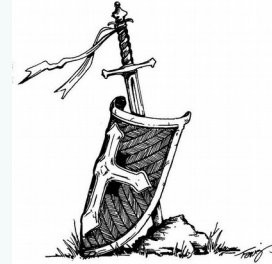
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- I'm Coding... In The Flow
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A Short Story

- I'm Coding... In The Flow
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- Suddenly...



A Short Story

- “Hey Cliff! What The **F@ck!** I showed off the new code to a customer and it crashed!”



A Short Story

- **“Hey Cliff! What The F@ck! I showed off the new code to a customer and it crashed!”**
- ... and I’m utterly unprepared
 - shocked into silence, peace shattered; code and angry words blurring in my head



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- **“You’re supposed to be a hot shot! Why didn’t you test it!”**



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- ... and I’m utterly unprepared
 - shocked into silence, peace shattered; code and angry words blurring in my head
- **“You’re supposed to be a hot shot! Why didn’t you test it!”**
 - ...of course I did; it’s still alpha code and has many known bugs...



A Short Story

- **“Your crap is crap, get outta my sight”**
 - ...and the attacker walks off
 - ...and I am left reeling



A Short Story

- **“Your crap is crap, get outta my sight”**
 - ...and the attacker walks off
 - ...and I am left reeling
- About an hour later I come up with the snappy comeback
- But I never figure it out “in the moment”



Aftermath

- What just happened?
 - Why was I stun-locked by the verbal assault?
 - The speaker should have known the code was barely baked; the entire dev team certainly did



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- And why yell at me for doing something foolish?
 - Obviously the fool was not me...
 - **Wrong question:** “Why Fools Yell?” *is not important*



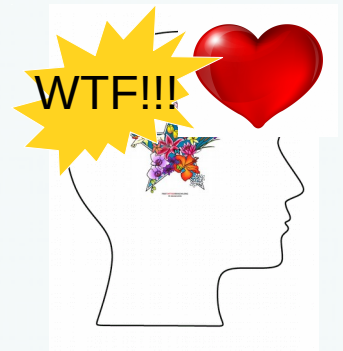
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 - **Wrong question:** “Why Fools Yell?” *is not important*
- **Right question:** “Why was I stun-locked?”



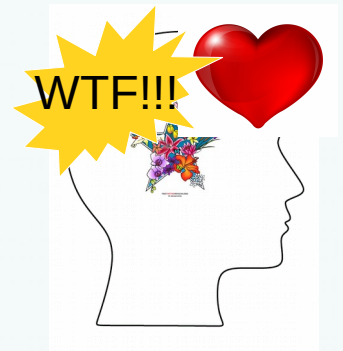
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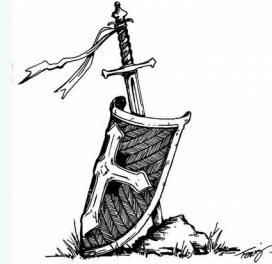


Figuring this out has been profound for me,
Because I now **compensate** for it



A Short Story, Again

- I'm Coding... In The Flow
- My Creativity is Up
- My Emotional Armor is Down
- Suddenly...



A Short Story, Again

- “Hey Cliff! What The **F@ck!** ...”
 - This is a verbal assault on my ego
 - I’m recovering; doing emotional processing
 - Fight or Flight response is kicking in
 - Head still full of code logics
- Before I get to figure out what he did and why he is mad...



A Short Story, Again

- “You’re supposed to be a hot shot! Why didn’t you test it!”
 - A 2nd verbal attack, this one ad-hominem
 - “...supposed to be...” directly against self-esteem
 - “Why didn’t you test it?!” - example of poor skills
 - Like most people, I am proud of my skills
 - This is me emotionally processing this attack
 - Ego guard is up; further id-assaults blocked
 - I start to make judgment calls on *his* character



A Short Story, Again

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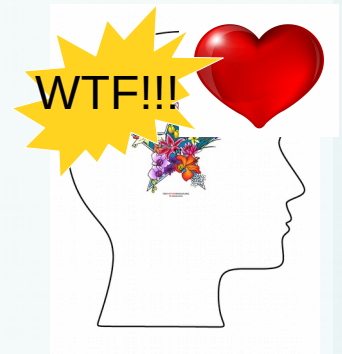
A Short Story, Again

- “Your crap is crap, get outta my sight”
 - ...and the attacker walks off
- I am **emotionally wrecked**
 - Pulled completely out of the Flow
 - My adrenaline is flowing, ready to fight-or-flight
 - It’ll be hours before I am calm enough to code again



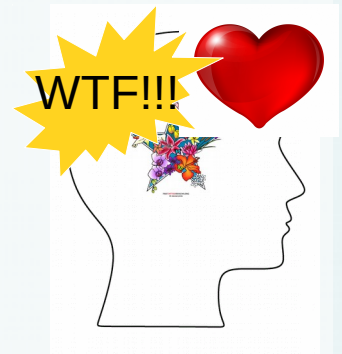
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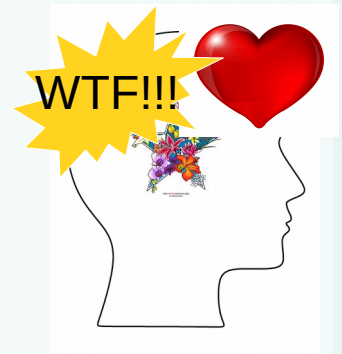
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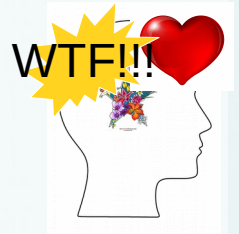
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- ***Decades*** pass before I realize:



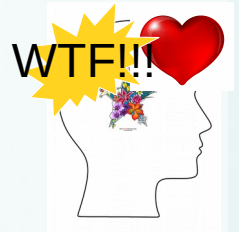
Aftermath, Again

- *I can't do verbal processing and emotional processing at the same time*



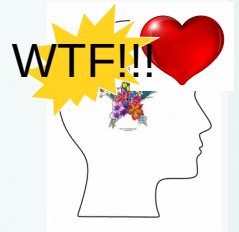
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- *I can't do verbal processing and emotional processing at the same time*
- A verbal assault starts me emotional processing
 - Why am I being attacked?
 - Am I not worthy?
- I'll not have any words until I sort myself out



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What can I do about it?



Action Plan

- I can not make up words during the assault



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- I can **memorize** words beforehand
 - Rote words; blind words; useful for all such attacks:



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“I need space. I’m leaving.”

- ***And walk away*** 
- That’s it!!! Hang up the phone, block the texts
- Walk or run... **End the Assault**



End The Assault

- Walk or run... block / ignore / cancel
 - *Leave the attacker behind*
- Nobody needs Abuse
- And that's what it is, pure and simple: Abuse



End The Assault

- Walk or run... block / ignore / cancel
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- Nobody needs Abuse
- And that's what it is, pure and simple: Abuse
- I find my non-word non-verbal Silence
- In the Peace – I find my Zen
 - And know that I am not to blame
 - **I Am Worthy!!!!**



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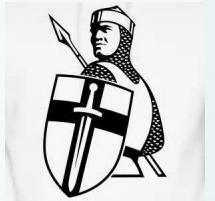
Anger

- “Hey Cliff! WTF! ... Your crap is crap.”
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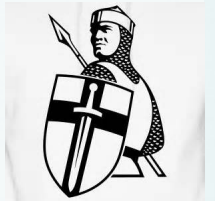
Anger

- “Hey Cliff! WTF! ... Your crap is crap.”
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- The Fight is over for the Fool, but not for me!
 - My Warrior has picked up my Ego armor
 - Adrenaline is pumping: Fight or Flight



Anger

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 - And the Fool walks away
- The Fight is over for the Fool, but not for me!
 - My Warrior has picked up my Ego armor
 - Adrenaline is pumping: Fight or Flight
- Stress does not just “fade away”
 - Sticks around, maybe a long time. Maybe *years*
 - I’m angry **now**
 - **My body demands I Act Now!!!**



“Kick the Dog!”

- I’m angry; I want to attack somebody, **anybody**
 - Smart enough not to attack somebody dangerous
 - I want to attack somebody who is **safe** to attack:
 - the dog; spouse; kids; person next to me...



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 - I want to attack somebody who is **safe** to attack:
 - the dog; spouse; kids; person next to me...
- I’m angry *at the Fool*, but I’ll attack *who is safe*

Wrong, Twice!



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- Once, because I end up attacking those who are trying to help me
 - Innocent bystanders, feeling my pain and trying to help



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- Once, because I end up attacking those who are trying to help me
 - Innocent bystanders, feeling my pain and trying to help
- Twice, because my Anger isn't directed at source
 - The Fool is safe to attack me again
- And yet... I still need to get the Anger out
 - Stewing on it leads to Depression
 - High stress causes all kinds of health issues



Out, Not At

- Key:

Get the Anger Out, Not At

- Must do a ***physical*** activity to get adrenaline **out**
- Not **at** means do not focus at somebody
- Go for a run, go to the gym, take a walk, tennis court, picture the Fool's face on a ball and smash it until the sweat rises and the anger fades



Working Through The Emotions

- Next step – once the Anger fades
 - Work through the emotions
 - Accepting what happened, and moving on
 - “Harvest the Best, Toss the Rest”



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 - “Harvest the Best, Toss the Rest”
- For me, talking to The Village works
 - Friends & family, co-workers, strangers, whoever
- For you, might be different
 - Painting, singing, writing, sailing, meditation, long quiet hikes in a beautiful place



Working Through The Emotions

- Know I Need Time to sort it out
 - Give myself the Time & Space



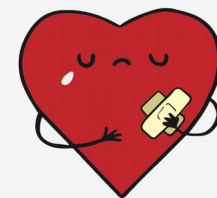
Working Through The Emotions

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- When the hub-bub of life settles down, kids are in bed, and quiet descends on the world
 - Don't reach for noise-makers to fill the Space
 - Leave the TV & movie off, avoid loud friends & drinks



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 - Leave off the TV & movie, avoid loud friends & drinks
- **Work through what happened**
 - Just like any body injury I need time to heal
 - Give my soul some healing time



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A More Personal Story

- This same pattern shows up in my love life
 - Married 20 years; divorced a decade ago
 - I dated a bunch after my divorce
 - A few months in, things going well
 - At some point I always got: “Cliff, do you love me?”
- And I’m speechless



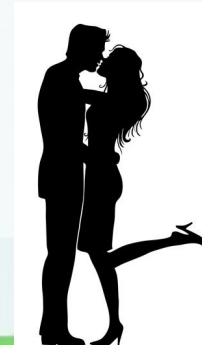
A More Personal Story

- I'm thinking:
 - What if I say 'no'? Will she walk away?
 - Is she so concerned with love at this point?
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A More Personal Story

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 - What if I say 'no'? Will she walk away?
 - Is she so concerned with love at this point?
 - I like her a lot, but 'love' so soon? No, takes longer
- As for my actual feelings,
that's a deep soul search
 - Which I can't do while she's hanging on to me and whispering in my ear
 - Too distracted physically



A More Personal Story

- And in my silence, she reads what?
 - Rejection? More worries, more concerns
- I'm “stun locked” doing emotional processing



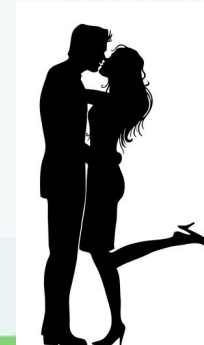
A More Personal Story

- And in my silence, she reads what?
 - Rejection? More worries, more concerns
- I'm "stun locked" doing emotional processing
- Same solution: prepare a verbal response:
 - "I really like you, but it's not love, at least not yet. I don't know really. I have to search my soul to answer, and I can't do that now, that takes days."



A More Personal Story

- Same pattern in my **sex** life
 - Sex is highly emotional for me
- I **cannot** talk during the act
 - No amount of poking or prodding has changed that
- I **can** listen, and act on gentle guiding words
- I **can** speak with actions
- Same solution:
 - Speak the words in the light of day,
before the emotions hit



Another's Story

- Same pattern – in other people all around
- Somebody is Excited about a solution!!!
 - Which they are sharing loudly and excitedly!!!
 - A few others get excited, talking out problems, sharing solutions, brainstorming...



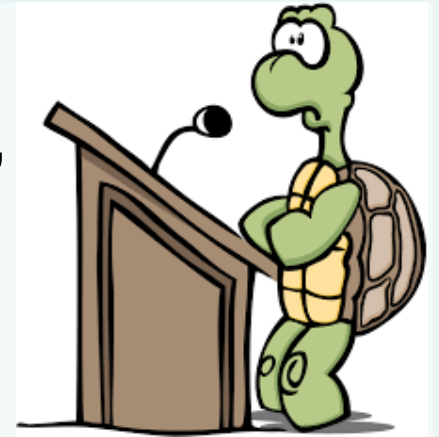
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- ... quietly sitting in the corner, is somebody with a bright idea, maybe the best idea
 - Too afraid to speak up



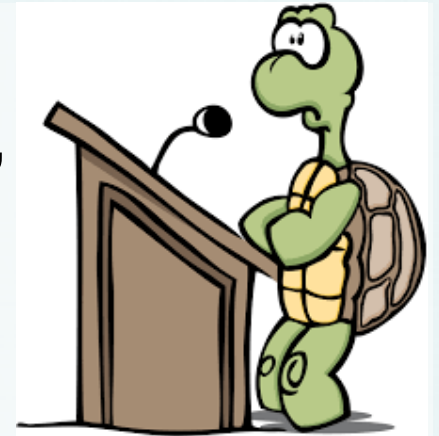
Another's Story

- They're thinking:
 - “What if I’m wrong? I’ll look like a fool!”
 - “I wish I could talk, but I can’t”
 - “They won’t believe me anyways”
 - “I’m not worthy”



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 - “I wish I could talk, but I can't”
 - “They won't believe me anyways”
 - “I'm not worthy”
- They're doing **emotional processing** and cannot come up with words



Another's Story

- From the outside, looking in, it's easy to spot
 - A loud few, sharing loudly
 - ... and quiet intent listeners



Another's Story

- From the outside, looking in, it's easy to spot
 - A loud few, sharing loudly
 - ... and quiet intent listeners
- As a Leader, I need to step in
 - Not to shut down the brainstorming
 - Nor the brainstormers
 - But to make a **verbal space** – and acknowledge that the quiet ones are also worthy
 - A safer place for quiet thinkers to speak up



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 - Their ego might need feeding also
 - So I acknowledge:



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 - And then, after the question is answered...



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 - So I acknowledge:
- “Larry, I heard you suggest XXX, is that right”?
 - No shutdown, no claims of right-or-wrong
 - And then, after the question is answered...
- “I see some quiet listeners, anybody else want to chime in?”
 - And a **verbal space** will appear



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Ex: Programmers, Doctors, Experts
- Warrior: revels in the Fight. “Closed the deal!”
Ex: CEOs, Lawyers, used-car salesmen



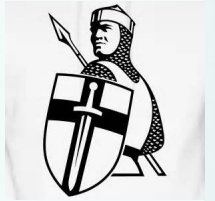
Aspects: Farmer, Magi, Warrior

- These aspects show up again and again
 - In my stories and responses
 - In my actions or lack-of-actions
 - In my prep for situations I well know are coming...
- Useful tool to understand myself
 - Know thy strengths
 - ... And thy weaknesses
 - And so can better compensate



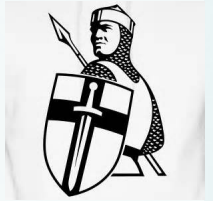
Introverts & Warrior Skills

- Programmers, conflict-avoiders, introverts do not practice their Warrior very much
 - Warrior is unskilled and naive
 - Easily pushed into defensive by skilled Warriors
 - Dominated by “alpha males”



Introverts & Warrior Skills

- Programmers, conflict-avoiders, introverts do not practice their Warrior very much
 - Warrior is unskilled and naive
 - Easily pushed into defensive by skilled Warriors
 - Dominated by “alpha males”
- How would a Warrior handle my Story?
 - Imagine a NYC Lawyer on the receiving end of
 - Fool: “Hey Cliff! WTF!....”
 - Warrior: “You’re the [f@cking](#) idiot! That was a fool thing to do!”
 - Verbal assault easily returned tit-for-tat



Red, Yellow, and Green People

- **Greens** – People who are **safe** to be around
 - Friends you trust, honest councilors, no “hurting words”, no sarcasm, you can share freely with



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- **Yellows** – People in the **middle**
 - You drop your guard carefully



Why Flag People?

- Brings your Magi into your relationships!
 - And your Magi is possibly your strongest aspect
 - Make intelligent cost / benefit trade-offs



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- Brings your Magi into your relationships!
 - And your Magi is possibly your strongest aspect
 - Make intelligent cost / benefit trade-offs
- Ex: **Angry Ann**; full of biting sarcasm; dark humor; crazy fun party animal...
 - Is hanging around her worth it? Sometimes? Always? Never?
 - Bring your Magi to bear



Why Flag People?

- Know your **Greens:** mine is my brother
 - Divorce is On, boss yelled, health claim denied, speeding ticket, whatever...
 - I **know** who to reach out for support
 - And knowing that alone mitigates much of the trauma
 - Know thy Greens and Use Them



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 - I **know** who to reach out for support
 - And knowing that alone mitigates much of the trauma
 - Know thy Greens and Use Them
- People really do like helping each other
- It's always very life-affirming when I end up being somebody else's Green



Lose The Reds

- Really!!! Try as hard as you can to lose the Reds
 - You aren't going to change them
 - You don't need all that stress & negativity
 - Your passion, love & skill will all suffer when you are busy defending against a Red



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 - Boss, Parent, Spouse
 - You can get trapped in **Siege Mode**
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Slowly beaten down into a mass of sadness
- Cry For Help!!! Get to a hospital ER!!!



How To Lose The Reds

- Kinda-sorta-friends?
 - Pick your social activities with care
 - Bail out as-needed
- Boss / co-worker?
 - Complain uphill – **facts** are crucial here, he-said / she-said is not productive.
 - Worse-case: New job. Life is too short to hate work
- Spouse? +kids?
 - Marriage / Talk Therapy – get it and get it Now



Love, Change and Mind Reading

- **No matter how much you Love somebody
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Love, Change and Mind Reading

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Love, Change and Mind Reading

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 - Change comes from **within**, not without
 - I cannot change **you**. Only you can do that.

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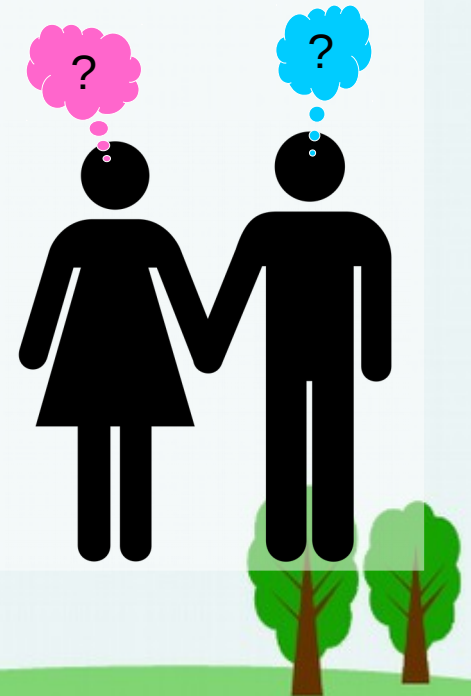
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 - Change comes from **within**, not without
 - **I** cannot change **you**. Only you can do that.
 - I might want You to Change badly,
You might know it, but unless
You decide to Change,
My wishes are for nought.
- And vice-versa...

i
love
you
this
much
∞

Love, Change and Mind Reading

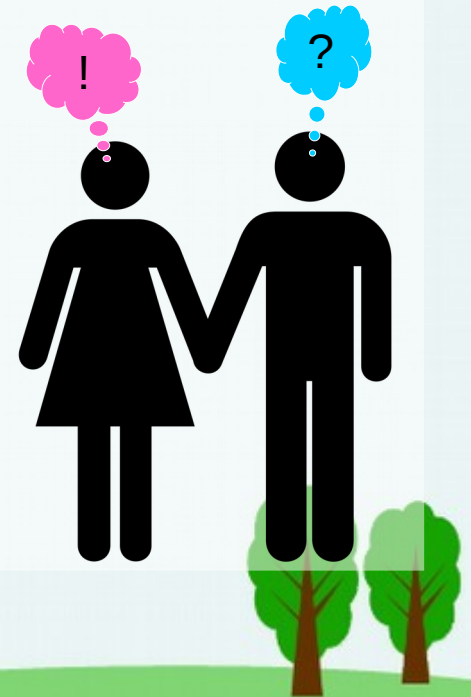
- No matter how much you Love somebody,
You **cannot** Read Their Mind, Nor They Yours
 - So much broken expectations come from this



Love, Change and Mind Reading

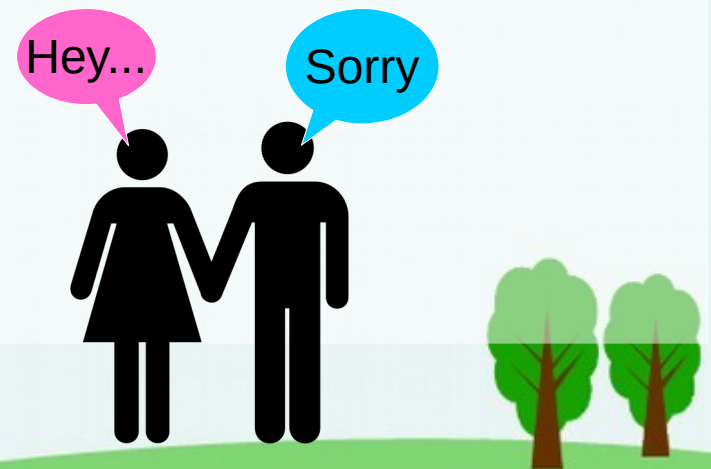
- No matter how much you Love somebody,
You **cannot** Read Their Mind, Nor They Yours
 - So much broken expectations come from this
- Your partner did something that hurt you.
 - Did they do it on purpose?
Why would they hurt me?

“I just need to love them more,
and they’ll stop hurting me”



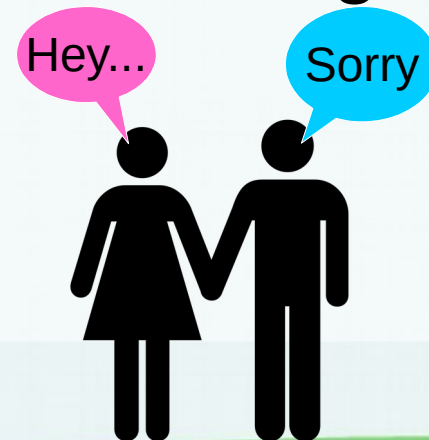
Love, Change and Mind Reading

- Much more likely:
 - Partner has no idea you got hurt
 - Mention it: “hey, you know I really got hurt there”
 - “What??? Wait, no!! I didn’t mean to hurt you!”
 - And maybe: “How did that hurt? I don’t understand!”



Love, Change and Mind Reading

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 - Partner has no idea you got hurt
 - Mention it: “hey, you know I really got hurt there”
 - “What??? Wait, no!! I didn’t mean to hurt you!”
 - And maybe: “How did that hurt? I don’t understand!”
- And if they care enough, they will Change
 - Not by you Loving them,
 - But by their Love for you.



Agenda

- A Short Story About Emotional Processing
- Emotional Strategies & Anger Management
- More Short Stories
- More Strategies
- **Salary Negotiations**
- Wrap Up



Salary Negotiations

- Funny joke heard recently:

Fighting with a Lawyer is like
wrestling with a Pig in the mud.
The Lawyer enjoys it,
you're going to get really dirty,
and you are very unlikely to win.



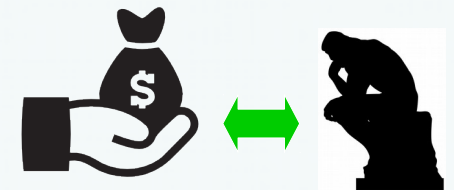
Salary Negotiations

- Same with Used Car Salesmen
 - They sell cars to non-Warriors every day
 - It's what they do; nothing personal about it
 - It's just their job, and they are certainly good at it



Salary Negotiations

- Same with Used Car Salesmen
 - They sell cars to non-Warriors every day
 - It's what they do; nothing personal about it
 - It's just their job, and they are certainly good at it
- Same with Human Resources
 - They negotiate salaries every day
 - Nothing personal about, no emotions attached
 - It's just their job – to get **your** skills at the best price



Salary Negotiations

- H-R rep has a salary range in mind
 - And a skill-set / recommendation
 - Their job: get the requested skills at lowest price
 - And they are looking at lots of candidates
 - And after: step out of the picture; no hard feelings, no regrets, & no real interaction with hiring team
- But it is your life!
And you standard-of-living for years to come!



Salary Negotiations – The Fight

- After the pleasant “Hello, how are you”s...
 - The H-R rep, like any good Warrior, fires an (acceptable) verbal attack:
 - “So, how much are you making now?” or “How much do you need?”



Salary Negotiations – The Fight

- After the pleasant “Hello, how are you”s...
 - The H-R rep, like any good Warrior, fires an (acceptable) verbal attack:
 - “So, how much are you making now?” or “How much do you need?”
- And immediately I’m thinking:
 - If I tell, I’ll only get offered a little above that!
 - I know I’m worth more!
 - How is my self-worth being judged by a number?



Salary Negotiations – The Fight

- i.e., I am emotionally processing...
 - And my unskilled Warrior is on the defensive
 - Pretty soon, I'm backed into the "I really need this job!" corner and "I better tell him!"



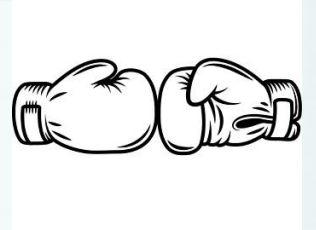
Salary Negotiations – The Fight

- i.e., I am emotionally processing...
 - And my unskilled Warrior is on the defensive
 - Pretty soon, I'm backed into the "I really need this job!" corner and "I better tell him!"
- And the Fight is lost hardly before it has begun
 - I get the expected lame offer
 - And am feeling underappreciated for years to come



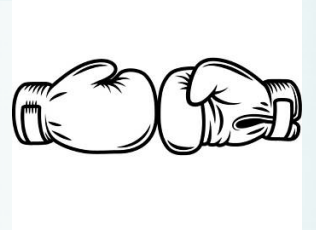
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 - It's polite & civil; I volunteered to be there
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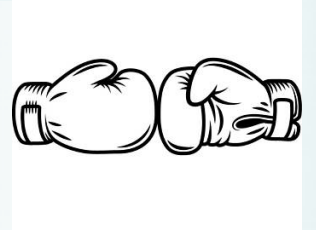
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Salary Negotiations – The Fight

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 - It's polite & civil; I volunteered to be there
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 - Prepare and Practice the Fight
- Your Magi will do the preparations
- But your Warrior will be doing the Fighting
 - And So Your Warrior also needs the **Practice**



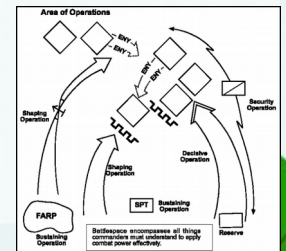
Salary Negotiations - Preparation

- Prepare!
 - Know Thy Worth – glassdoor.com, monster.com, dice.com, dozens of job boards.
 - Read books on job interviewing



Salary Negotiations - Preparation

- Prepare!
 - Know Thy Worth – glassdoor.com, monster.com, dice.com, dozens of job boards.
 - Read books on job interviewing
- BATNA – Go look it up
 - “Best Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement”
 - It’s what you get when you don’t get what you want
 - It’s your “Plan B”, your fall-back position
 - Your Warrior will need this info readily



Salary Negotiations - Practice

- Practice!
 - Practice (unlike prep) hits you in a different place
 - Trains a different Warrior muscle
 - Prep gives you intellectual ammo, and lets you **think** through what to do: Your Magi is at Work
- Your Warrior turns Knowledge into Action
 - And this is exactly what you **most** need to practice



Salary Negotiations

- Get a partner to play H-R
 - Set up like the Real Deal; desk; office; timing
 - Partner in the “Power Seat”
 - You dress up nice, out of your “comfort zone”
- Play out the negotiation
 - How to respond to common questions
 - Keeping your emotions “in check”
 - Test how you handle failures & negative feedback



Salary Negotiations

- Practice answering common questions
 - “How much are you making now?”
 - No need to give facts, but must answer question
 - “I’m asking \$XXX because of my great skills”
- Spend The Time
 - A better salary is totally worth a few hours spent



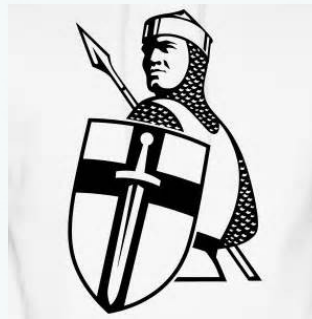
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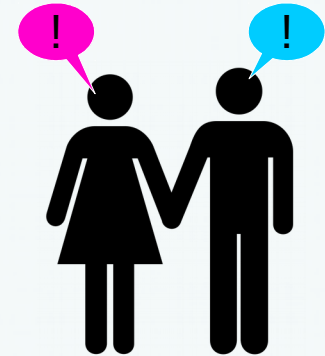
Self-Awareness

- Salary Negotiations
 - Acknowledge it's a Fight
 - And like any Fight, Prepare and Practice
 - Preparation uses your strong Magi
 - Practice helps your not-so-strong Warrior
 - Give your Inner Warrior a fighting chance!



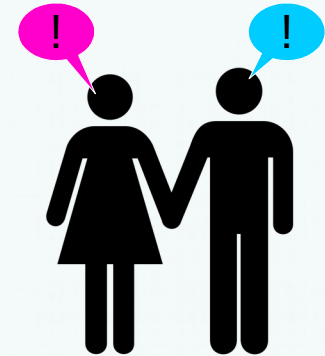
Self-Awareness

- Love does Not Change All, just Changes You
 - ...and you suck as a Mind Reader
- So Ask, don't Assume



Self-Awareness

- Love does Not Change All, it just Changes You
 - ...and you suck as a Mind Reader
- So Ask, don't Assume
- Green, Yellow, Red People
 - Make the judgment call
 - Note: you are not declaring a Red “bad”, just “bad for me”
 - Lose the Reds
 - Learn that you can lean on the Greens



Self-Awareness

- When the attack is emotional: Leave!
 - Find Space, find Peace, find your Zen



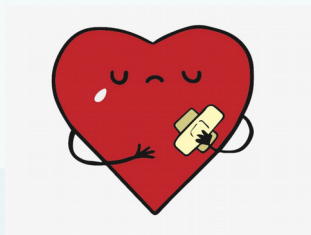
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Self-Awareness

- When the attack is emotional: Leave!
 - Find Space, find Peace, find your Zen
- Anger: Out, Not At
 - Physical activity to release anger & stress
 - Unreleased anger turns into depression
- Time & Space for Soul Healing
 - Honor your wound, give yourself a healing time



A Life Journey

- Self-Awareness is a Life-long Journey
- We are all at different places
 - People can be stuck for decades
 - And then move forwards again
 - You've met old men who behave like children
 - “He who dies with the most toys Wins!!!”
 - And heard Wisdom from the mouth of Babies
- Do not judge others for where they are
 - As in turn, you may not wish to be judged





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